

Cloud Security Checklist

A practical checklist for hardening cloud environments before production.

Identity & Access Management

- Enforce multi-factor authentication (MFA) on all accounts
- Follow least-privilege access — no unnecessary admin rights
- Rotate access keys and credentials regularly
- Disable unused or default accounts

Network Security

- Restrict security groups/firewall rules to required ports only
- Disable public access on databases and storage by default
- Use a VPN or private network for internal services
- Enable logging on all network traffic (VPC flow logs, etc.)

Data Protection

- Encrypt data at rest and in transit
- Enable versioning and backups on storage buckets
- Set clear data retention and deletion policies
- Audit who has access to sensitive data stores

Monitoring & Response

- Enable audit logging (CloudTrail, Activity Log, etc.)
- Set up alerts for unusual account activity
- Have an incident response plan documented
- Regularly review and rotate secrets/API keys

Before Going to Production

- Run a vulnerability scan on all public-facing services
- Remove any test/demo resources and credentials
- Confirm backups are tested and restorable
- Document your architecture and access policies